

Tuesday, June 23 — Lucerne (full free day)

Big picture: your first true rest day. Easy city day, or a scenic Mount Rigi half-day. Let the weather decide.

Option A — Relaxed city day

- From the hotel, walk to the **Kapellbrücke (Chapel Bridge)** — Europe's oldest covered wooden bridge (c. 1365), with 17th-century paintings in the rafters and the octagonal Water Tower beside it.
- Wander the **Old Town squares** (Hirschenplatz, Weinmarkt) with their painted façades, then walk ~10 min to the **Lion Monument** — Mark Twain's "most mournful piece of stone in the world." The **Glacier Garden** next door is an easy, fun 45–60 min add-on (mirror maze, prehistoric potholes).
- Long lakeside lunch on the promenade near **Schwanenplatz**. Keep the day unhurried.

Option B — Mount Rigi half-day (if weather is clear)

1. Walk to the **lake piers** by the station (~5 min). Take a **boat to Vitznau** across the lake.
2. At Vitznau, board the **cogwheel railway** (Europe's oldest mountain rack railway) up to **Rigi Kulm** (1,798 m).
3. Up top: café terraces, sun loungers, and gentle level paths with views to Pilatus, the Alps, and the lakes. Rigi is far gentler than Pilatus — minimal walking, lots of places to sit.
4. Return by train + boat to Lucerne by mid-afternoon, then ease into the Old Town for dinner. Budget 4–5 hrs round trip.

HEADS UP · Mountain-weather rule

Before committing to Rigi, check the live **cable-car / summit webcams** that morning (the operators post them). If the peak is socked in, you'll see clouds, not views — switch to the Old Town day. After yesterday's long travel day, the relaxed city day is a perfectly good call regardless of weather.

Ask about a transport pass

If your rail booking didn't already include a Swiss Travel Pass or Half-Fare Card, the boat + Rigi railway (and tomorrow's options) add up fast. Worth a quick question to your travel agent before you start buying point-to-point mountain tickets.